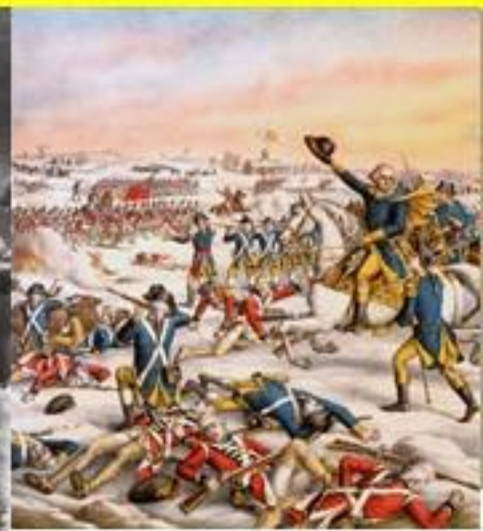


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 34

SECOND WORLD WAR - 1

- 1** The First World War came to an end in 1918 and the Paris Peace conference was held in 1919.
- 2** Many treaties including the Treaty of Versailles were signed in the conference.
- 3** One of the important features of this conference was that only the victorious nations alone were invited.
- 4** The conference turned out to be a meeting of the victors to share the spoils of the war.

- 5** The defeated countries were badly treated.



6 They also discussed about the establishment of permanent peace in the world.

7 In order to solve mutual problems among the nations, under the initiative of the U.S. President Woodrow Wilson, the League of Nations had been established.

8 But the League failed to maintain the expected international peace.

9 This ultimately led to the rise of dictatorships in Germany, Italy and Japan.

10 The formation of Rome, Berlin, Tokyo Axis led to the Second World War.



1 HUMILIATION OF GERMANY

- Germany was defeated in the First World War.
 - She was not invited to the Paris Peace Conference.
 - Germany was forced to sign a harsh and humiliating treaty.
 - German territories were taken away from her.
 - She was deprived of her colonies.
 - Her navy was completely disbanded.
- Her army was reduced considerably.
 - The Weimar Republic was not in a position to solve the post-war problems.
 - The German people decided to take revenge for their humiliation.
 - In fact, the Second World War was a war of retaliation.
 - Therefore, the Treaty of Versailles had in itself the seeds of the Second World War.



2 RISE OF DICTATORSHIPS

1 The inter-war period witnessed the rise of dictatorships in Europe. The inter-war period is otherwise called the period of dictators.

2 Germany, Italy, Spain and Japan witnessed the rise of dictators.

3 Germany:

- In Germany, the Weimar Republic was weak.
- Hitler, the leader of the Nazi Party took full advantage of the weakness of the Republican Government and brought the government under his control. He started aggression.
- He captured Austria and Czechoslovakia.
- At last he attacked Poland and World War II started.



2 RISE OF DICTATORSHIPS

4 Italy:

- The same condition prevailed in Italy also.
- Italy felt that it was deceived in the Paris Peace Conference.
- Mussolini started the Fascist Party.
- In 1922 he captured power and became a dictator.
- He also followed an aggressive foreign policy.



2 RISE OF DICTATORSHIPS

5 Spain:

- In Spain, General Franco defeated the Republican Government and established his dictatorship.
- In this effort, he was assisted by the armies of Hitler and Mussolini.



6 Japan:

- Japan became a partner of Hitler and Mussolini by signing the Rome-Berlin-Tokyo Axis.
- This alliance disturbed world peace and the Second World War started.



3 DEVELOPMENT OF MILITARISM

- 1 The failure of the disarmament efforts after the First World War was a major reason for the outbreak of a new War.
- 2 In the Paris Peace conference Germany was forced to disarm itself.
- 3 The German Government demanded disarmament of the victorious powers, in the same way as she had been disarmed.
- 4 As they refused, Germany under the dictatorship of Hitler increased its military strength.
- 5 Owing to the immense increase in armaments and the development of militarism, the Second World War became inevitable.



4 POLICY OF IMPERIALISM

- 1 The policy of imperialism was **one of the causes** for the Second World War.
- 2 It was this **same feeling of imperialism** which played a **dominant role** during the First World War.
- 3 Germany and Japan, who were **more imperialistic** than the Allied powers, simply ignored the decisions of the **Paris Peace Conference**. They made their efforts to **expand their respective territories**.
- 4
 - Hitler occupied **Rhineland, Austria, Memel, Czechoslovakia** and incorporated them into **German territory**.
 - Mussolini occupied **Abyssinia** and launched a series of **aggressive activities**.
 - Japan attacked **Manchuria** and captured it from China.



5 RAT RACE FOR COLONIES

- 1 There was also a race for colonies among the European countries in order to obtain raw materials and markets for their industrial growth.
- 2 This trend continued among these powers even after the First World War.
- 3 Germany was deprived of all her colonies at the Paris Peace Conference.
- 4 Italy was dissatisfied with the treatment of Allied Powers.
- 5 Japan, a powerful Asiatic country wanted to have colonies to enrich its resources.

- 6 It is in these circumstances Germany, Italy and Japan decided to follow aggressive foreign policy.
- 7 These aggressive actions ultimately led to the Second World War.



6 FAILURE OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

- 1 After the First World War, the League of Nations was established to solve controversies among the nations and to maintain permanent peace and order in the world.
- 2 Even the members of the League failed to respect the provisions of the covenant of the League.
- 3 Those who violated the provisions simply walked out of the League, without any punishment.
- 4 The League could not contain the Japanese annexation of Manchuria and Italian invasion of Abyssinia.
- 5 Hitler's activities posed a challenge to the League.
- 6 Thus, the failure of the League of Nations to control aggressive countries was a major cause for World War II.



7 DISSATISFACTION OF NATIONAL MINORITIES

- 1** The Allied powers though posed themselves as the champions of the principle of self-determination, in actual practice that principle was not followed by them.
- 2** In some parts of Central Europe, the problem of national minorities existed.
- 3** It is these minority groups which became the hot beds of discontent and dissatisfaction.
- 4** German annexation of Austria and Sudetenland and attack on Poland was based on this policy of reunion of National minorities.



8 MUTUAL DIFFERENCES OF THE ALLIES

- 1 There was no collective cooperation among the Allies.
- 2 England followed a policy appeasement towards Germany.
- 3 France's fear of Germany was opposed by England.
- 4 The U.S.A., the architect of the League of Nations, did not join the League.
- 5 These differences among the allies failed to check the increasing strength of the dictators.



9 POLICY OF APPEASEMENT

- 1 In May 1937, Neville Chamberlain became Prime Minister of Britain.
- 2 He believed that the Treaty of Versailles had treated Germany badly and that there were a number of issues associated with the Treaty that needed to be put right.
- 3 He felt that giving in to Hitler's demands would prevent another war.
- 4 This policy, adopted by Chamberlain's government became known as the policy of Appeasement.
- 5 In nut shell the policy of Britain and France not to react and take action on the unreasonable demands of Germany is termed as Policy of Appeasement.



9 POLICY OF APPEASEMENT

- 6 Adhered to the Appeasement policy Britain and France did not intervene and objected when Hitler denied Treaty of Versailles, remilitarized Rhineland and annexed Austria and Czechoslovakia.
- 7 Some historians are of the view that if Britain and France would have intervened initially after Hitler defied Treaty of Versailles or remilitarized Rhineland the Second World War could have been avoided.
- 8 As by that time Germany was weak and also it was this phase of initial successes of Hitler in terms of Foreign policy which made him immensely popular and unopposed leader in Germany.



- 1** The four countries of Germany, Italy, France, and Great Britain composed and signed the Munich pact on September 29, 1938.
- 2** Hitler demanded for the secession of the German-speaking Sudetenland of Czechoslovakia to Germany.
- 3** German leaders argued and insisted that the government of Czechoslovakia were discriminatory toward the Sudeten people and the secession of Sudetenland to Germany would justify to their request for self-determination.
- 4** Great Britain and France agreed to Hitler's demands when he promised not to annex other parts of Czechoslovakia.
- 5** Ironically, Czechoslovakia whose fate was at stake was not consulted in the pact.



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